



Meeting the troops

Nixon greets members of the First Infantry Division at their base camp in Di An, south of Saigon, in July 1969, during his first visit to Vietnam as president of the United States.

“I’m **going to stop the war. Fast.**”

RICHARD NIXON TO CHIEF OF STAFF H. R. HALDEMAN, 1969

» AFTER

Frustrated by the failure of his military and diplomatic moves, Nixon looked for alternative ways to deliver “peace with honor.”

A NEW STRATEGY

Nixon knew that he had to try to end US intervention in Vietnam while preserving the credibility of his leadership at home and that of America abroad. As they turned to **Vietnamization** and diplomacy, Kissinger and Nixon spoke privately, not of victory in Vietnam, but of making South Vietnam strong enough to survive for a decent interval after US withdrawal. They wanted to avoid the appearance of abandoning an ally.